

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 886

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Alex Forsbach upon his receipt of the 2026 National Conservation Legacy Award from the American Soybean Association.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those Tennessee farmers who, through their stewardship of the land and commitment to sound conservation practices, strengthen our agricultural heritage and help ensure a sustainable future; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Alex Forsbach of Savannah, who was presented with the 2026 National Conservation Legacy Award by the American Soybean Association (ASA) during the ASA Awards Celebration at Commodity Classic in San Antonio, Texas; and

WHEREAS, in addition to this national distinction, Mr. Forsbach was previously selected as the 2026 South Region winner of the Conservation Legacy Award, reflecting his leadership in conservation among soybean producers throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, the Conservation Legacy Award is a national program designed to recognize the outstanding environmental achievements of soybean farmers that help produce more sustainable U.S. soybeans; nominees are evaluated by a national selection committee composed of soybean farmers, conservationists, agronomists, and natural resource professionals based on their on-farm legacy of conservation practices and outreach efforts in their local communities; and

WHEREAS, Alex Forsbach grew up working on his family's farm in Savannah, where he helped raise corn, soybeans, grain sorghum, and wheat; he has noted that this early experience helped shape his passion for agriculture and laid the foundation for his own farming journey; and

WHEREAS, while attending Mississippi State University, Mr. Forsbach returned to the family farm in mid-2008 to assist with the installation of four center pivots, and, following his graduation in 2009, he began his own farming operation by renting 163 acres and purchasing a self-propelled sprayer; and

WHEREAS, today, through his Growing Acres farm, located along the Tennessee River just below Pickwick Dam, Alex Forsbach produces soybeans, grain sorghum, winter wheat, and occasionally corn, continuing the agricultural tradition that first inspired him; and

WHEREAS, through his work at Growing Acres, Alex Forsbach has demonstrated that land stewardship and conservation practices can make a meaningful difference in farm operations, noting a significant increase in soil organic matter over the past ten years, which he attributes directly to his use of no-till methods and cover crops; and

WHEREAS, given the ups and downs of today's agricultural economy, Mr. Forsbach has identified diversification as key to managing the risks associated with innovative farming practices; together with his wife, Katherine, he opened a seed dealership in 2014, a rural primary care medical clinic in 2019, and invested in and helped found AgLaunch, which enables farmers to trial new technologies, gain an equity stake in their companies, and bring grain sorghum into their crop rotation; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Forsbach has emphasized that conservation plays a central role in creating and carrying out his farming legacy and has demonstrated conservation in action for his children and farm visitors while engaging others in thoughtful discussion about modern agriculture; and

WHEREAS, Alex Forsbach's achievements reflect great credit upon him, his family, and the Tennessee farming community and serve as a model of how innovation and environmental responsibility can work hand in hand to secure the future of agriculture; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Forsbach is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion;
now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH
GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF
REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Alex Forsbach upon his
receipt of the 2026 National Conservation Legacy Award from the American Soybean
Association and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success in all his future
endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared
for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to
the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear
without House or Senate designation.